

1 District 9

You would think that a film nominated for Best Picture among other Oscars in 2009 would be popular, but District 9 remains one of the most criminally under watched films of any genre. Directed by Neil Blomkamp, who later went on to make Elysium and Chappie and is attached to the Alien series, District 9 is a sci-fi classic tackling themes like xenophobia and social segregation, themes that are too heavy for the usual campy popcorn science fiction film. Set in an alternate Johannesburg in the 1980's



where a group of aliens have curiously decided to settle, District 9 tells the story of a man, Wikus who is sent to the impoverished alien slum for carrying out a relocation. The film features the most harrowing portrayal of aliens, far from the traditional trope we see in other popular franchises. The movie is smart, thrilling, and has tons of heart. That's more than we can say for most movies.

2 Snowpiercer

Snowpiercer is Korean auteur director Bong Joon-ho's first film in English, and he does a fantastic job of adapting this film from a French graphic novel. It follows a rebellion featuring the downtrodden end section of a train and the privileged rich people at the head section of the train. The train is no normal train, but a seemingly perpetual motion machine carrying all of what is left of humanity after a climate engineering experiment to counter global warming erased most of mankind. Far from the traditional apocalyptic depiction, the film instead uses the genre to elevate ideas of class structure and evolu-



tion. It features a brilliant performance by Chris Evans who leads the tail section rebellion and is visually stunning. There is one action sequence in particular that almost feels like poetry on screen, so visceral is it's choreography. Watch Snowpiercer if you enjoy intelligent films that use the medium of film not only for thematic and visual exhibition, but for social and cultural commentary as well.

3 28 Days Later

Much before Danny Boyle became popular with Slumdog Millionaire he made an underrated post apocalyptic thriller called 28 Days Later. The movie centres around a group of four people trying to survive amidst the outbreak of a lethal virus. You could call this film a zombie adventure but the treatment makes it stand



out among other popular zombie fare like Resident Evil. This movie is actually credited with starting the zombie boom in cinema. Written and shot in a unique style, 28 Days Later features scenes of the usually bustling London stripped of all activity. It's an extremely entertaining movie, horrifying and thrilling in equal measure.

But unlike usual horror movies, it's not content with just giving you chills but also functions as a human drama. 28 Days Later is a unique film that blends elements of horror, adventure and futurism with a stamp of artistic beauty that Danny Boyle has made his own.

